GLASSHOUSE

WOMEN ON TRACK



Illustration by SIDDHANT JUMDE

With **Jaya Varma Sinha** as its CEO, Indian Railways already has a woman at its head. Now, with another woman officer set to join the top echelon, the ladies may now well outnumber the men on the railway board, another first. With the recent elevation of 1986-batch IRTS officer **Seema Kumar** to Level 17, the rank of Secretary, of the Indian Railway Management Service, all eyes are now on the PM **Narendra Modi**-led Appointments Committee of the Union cabinet. For, if Kumar gets picked for the currently vacant post of Member (Operations and Business Development), three of the five Railway Board members would be women, including Anjali Goyal, Member (Finance).

A WAIT GETS LONGER

Suheldev Bharatiya Samaj Party president **O.P. Rajbhar** is an unhappy man these days. He had returned to the NDA fold in July with the assurance of a ministerial berth. He had even announced he'd take oath before Diwali. But there seems no sign of a cabinet expansion in Uttar Pradesh. Sources say Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath is not too keen and wants to wait till the results of the assembly polls in five states are announced on December 3. That can hardly be reassuring news for Rajbhar.



CHANDRADEEP KUMAR

The Original Yadavs



You can't ignore the Yadavs, the single largest caste group with over 14 per cent share in Bihar. RJD chief Lalu Yadav has a stranglehold on the cohort, but the BJP is not giving up on them without a try. Hence its first Milan Samaroh for Yadavs on November 14 in Patna, where 21,000-plus joined the BJP. And why wouldn't they gravitate toward PM Narendra Modi, who is from Gujarat, where Lord Krishna took shelter, asked BJP MLC **Naval Kishore Yadav**. Krishna and Kansa were the original Yadavs, and Krishna's descendants are natural allies. Who's Kansa then, Lalu shot back.

Wrong Note



There will be no Oscars for **A.R. Rahman** from West Bengal. The music composer has come in for flak for his rendition of Kazi Nazrul Islam's song, 'Karar Oi Louha Kopat' (The iron gates of the prison) for the film *Pippa*. Islam's popularity in Bengal is second only to Rabindranath Tagore's; he is also the national poet of Bangladesh. Parties of all colours—TMC, Congress, Left and BJP—have demanded that the song be removed from the film. Islam's family, too, has said that changing the tune was not part of the contract with the producers of the film. For once, Rahman seems out of tune.

Role Reversal

As deputy chief minister and finance minister, NCP leader **Ajit Pawar** has always had to battle charges by allies of favouring his legislators in the allocation of state funds. However, in a recent meeting with Union home minister Amit Shah, Pawar is said to have complained about MLAs from the BJP and Shiv Sena's Shinde faction of cornering the goodies. Is the shoe on the other foot now, Mr Deputy CM?



MANDAR DEODHAR

Kaushik Deka with Avishek Ghosh Dastidar, Arkamoy Datta Majumdar Prashant Srivastava, Amitabh Srivastava and Dhaval Kulkarni